

Dhāraṇī Called Vajra Heart, Descending Vajra Tongue

Vajrahṛdaya Vajrajihvānala Nāma Dhāraṇī · Toh 462 · Derge Kangyur

རྡོ་རྗེ་མཛེ་པ་རྡོ་རྗེ་ལྷ་ཉི་བཅ་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའ་གི་ཟུངས།

The Dhāraṇī Called "Vajra Heart, Descending Vajra Tongue," known in Sanskrit as the Vajrahṛdaya Vajrajihvānala Nāma Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Dorjé Nyingpo Dorjé Ché Babpa Shyejawé Zung, is a dhāraṇī text centered on a powerful mantra-incantation revealed by the Buddha while dwelling in the charnel ground of the Cool Grove. The text belongs to the dhāraṇī genre of Buddhist literature, which preserves sacred formulas believed to carry great protective and liberating power, and its narrative frame describes the Buddha entering a meditative absorption called Vajra Heart, from which radiant light emanates to relieve the suffering of all sentient beings throughout the cosmos. It is Toh 462 in the Kangyur, the collection of canonical texts attributed to the Buddha, and sits within the general class of dhāraṇī literature found in that collection.

In the language of India: Vajrahṛdaya Vajrajihvānala Nāma Dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: the dhāraṇī called "Vajra Heart, Descending Vajra Tongue."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was dwelling in the great charnel ground of the Cool Grove, together with a retinue of close son-bodhisattvas, śrāvakas, pratyekabuddhas, gods, humans, asuras, and nāgas.

Then the Blessed One entered into the meditative absorption called Vajra Heart. From his heart, brilliant rays of light burst forth, and those rays pervaded all the world-systems of the great trichiliocosm, freeing all sentient beings from every illness, discomfort, and suffering, and then returned into the heart of the Blessed One.

Then the great sage Nyéndor rose, paid homage, and addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, in this world-system all sentient beings are made to suffer and are laid low by illness, poison, epidemic disease, enemies, malevolent spirits, harmful sorcery, exorcism rites, excessive rainfall, failure of rain, and poor harvests. How are they to be guarded, protected, and sheltered from these?"

The Blessed One declared: "Great sage Nyéndor, there is a dhāraṇī called 'Vajra Heart, Descending Vajra Tongue,' and it guards, protects, and shelters

all sentient beings. I will now explain it. Listen well and hold it in mind."

Then the Blessed One uttered the syllables "Vajra vajra hūṃ," and Vajra Heart appeared in a wrathful, fierce, and terrifying aspect, and took his place to the side of the Blessed One.

Then the Blessed One, with one voice, declared this dhāraṇī:

Nī mā nān, dā nān,
klad pa nān,
ku na zhi tsi ta ku li nā na,
yakṣa bzlog byer.

The moment this dhāraṇī was spoken, all obstructing spirits and malevolent misleaders were terrified and panic-stricken, fell face-down, and vomited foam and fell unconscious.

Then even Ananta, the king of nāgas, trembled with fear in every limb, paid homage to the Blessed One, and spoke these words: "Blessed One, I wish to recite this dhāraṇī that destroys all enemies and malevolent spirits. May the Blessed One bestow his blessing upon it.

Namo buddhāya.

Citra mudrā, yakṣa bzlog byer."

The moment this dhāraṇī was uttered, the great earth shook, all world-systems toppled face-down, and all malevolent spirits and misleaders fell face-down, vomiting blood and losing their breath.

Then Ananta the nāga king spoke again: "Blessed One, I shall guard, protect, and shelter all sentient beings. I shall protect the teaching of the Blessed One. I shall cause the teaching of the buddhas to remain long in the world. I shall bring rain in due season and protect all harvests. I shall overcome every illness, enemy, and malevolent spirit. I shall not deviate from acting precisely as the Blessed One has commanded."

The Blessed One declared: "Excellent! Excellent! O Ananta, king of nāgas, act just as you have sworn. Guard and uphold your samaya pledge. Whoever transgresses my command shall fall into the lower realms. Carry out everything I have entrusted to you."

Then the Lord of Secrets, having read out the dhāraṇī called "Descending Vajra Tongue," proclaimed this fierce and supremely irresistible accomplishment-formula:

Nāga śig,
nāga byer,
nāga nān,
nāga go la nān.

Nāga hana hana, māra ya rbad nān. Sa don nag po sod, sa don nag po sod, sa don nag po nān. Phyu ga tsi phaṭ, tsi ga phyu phaṭ, lce ba ti phaṭ. E ga ra ba, tse di nāga ba ra ma, mahā pa la sa ta, ye go de, sad te nān, thum ril rbad. Che ge mo māra ya jaḥ rbad nān. Nāga hril hril, nāga phrom phrom, nāga phob. Vajra praveśa ya, sa 'di srungs śig byer ya, bhyor ma mahā āhūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.

The moment this dhāraṇī was proclaimed, fierce meteoric vajras descended from the sky and, slashing into pieces the bodies of all enemies, malevolent spirits, and whatever causes crop failure, reduced them utterly to fine dust.

Then the Blessed One declared the ritual procedure: O Great Sage, a square earth-maṇḍala shall be swept clean, then anointed with the five products of the cow. Anoint it with sandalwood and good fragrant incense. Scatter finely cut flowers. Set out a filled vase. Light butter-lamps. Place excellent tormas offerings. Plant iron or acacia kīla stakes. In the center place a vajra-core. In front of that, set out Ananta the nāga. Then, if one wishes to make offerings, offer the fivefold offering of flowers and the rest. If one wishes to make nāga offerings, do so with milk in a vessel with a ladle, along with various nāga medicines and various medicinal herbs. If one wishes to protect against illness and poison, use sesame oil, musk, blue thread, and peacock feathers. For the great black nāga, use sesame oil, musk, five-colored thread, and acacia stakes. For all spirits, use a stake and white mustard seed. For the demon of the dawn twilight, use a stake, white mustard seed, black mustard seed, kuṭaja plant, and great ash. For all wandering spirits, use five stakes and a skull. If one wishes to slay others, use a stake, an effigy, and a skull. If one wishes to suppress, use a skull, poison, and white mustard seed. If one wishes to destroy crops, apply these to a skull, poison, white mustard seed, sesame oil, and various bloods. If one wishes to protect the harvest, use great ash, kuṭaja plant, and stakes. For what is called "universal protection," if one wishes to reverse the evil spells of others, use a stūpa, an effigy, a skull, white mustard seed, and a stake. If one wishes to pacify all things, kindle a fire of sandalwood or cypress in an old hearth, and perform fire-offering with the three whites, the three sweets, rice, sesame, and white butter, reciting: "Che ge mo māra ya śātiṃ kuru svāhā" — and all shall be protected. If one wishes to

slay, kindle a fire of acacia or poisonous wood in a clay vessel, and perform fire-offering with various poisonous substances, kuṭaja plant, sesame, black butter, sesame oil, and the enemy's name-card, reciting: "Che ge mo ra śa māra ya rbad" — and all enemies and malevolent spirits shall be utterly destroyed. If one wishes to protect oneself and others, use the bile of a peacock, kāra plant, and earth-ambrosia five hundred years old. If one wishes to protect nāgas and earth-lords, use incense, black bdellium resin, musk, myrrh, lodong-ro plant, fragrant asafoetida, and honey. If one wishes supreme protection, use the three fruits, the self-arisen young cowrie, and fragrant water. For the great supreme extraordinary protection, hold the fruit of āmra that is all-victorious and recite this dhāraṇī:

Śig byer nān, 'go nān hana hana māra ya rbad nān.

O Great Sage of the expulsion of faults, hold this dhāraṇī firmly in mind. Guard, protect, and shelter all sentient beings. Uphold my teaching.

With these words the Blessed One concluded his proclamation, and to the Great Sage of the Expulsion of Faults, and —

— the entire assembled retinue together with gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced, and praised what the Blessed One had proclaimed.

Thus is completed the dhāraṇī called Vajra-essence, the Descent of the Vajra-tongue.

This was first translated by Ska-cog, and later by the great translator Nyan-lo-tsā-ba Dar—

Translator's Notes

- The name "Nyéndor" transliterates the Tibetan "ཡེན་དོར་" (lit. "Abandoner of Faults"), which here functions as a proper name or epithet for the sage who addresses the Blessed One; it may be a rendering of a Sanskrit name such as Pāpavihāna or similar, but no Sanskrit equivalent is given in the text.

The dhāraṇī syllables throughout are transliterated phonetically in the Tibetan and do not yield straightforward Sanskrit meanings; they are preserved here as they appear, following standard practice for mantra and dhāraṇī passages.

The "Lord of Secrets" (ཡེ་ཤེས་ཀྱི་ལོ་སྐྱོད་) is a standard epithet of Vajrapāṇi; his appearance here in the closing role of proclaiming the final dhāraṇī formula is a conventional feature of this genre of protective dhāraṇī texts.

- The bulk of this passage consists of mantra-syllables and dhāraṇī formulas transliterated phonetically from Sanskrit or hybrid Sanskrit into Tibetan. Following the established convention of this text, these are reproduced in romanized phonetic rendering rather than translated, as they are incantatory speech-acts rather than semantic content.

The substances listed in the ritual section — "three whites" (milk, yogurt, and butter), "three sweets" (molasses, honey, and sugar), kuṭaja plant, lodong-ro, kāra, and the "self-arisen young cowrie" — are standard Indic and Tibetan ritual and medicinal ingredients. Their identifications are conventional within the tradition, though some botanical identifications remain debated among scholars; this does not affect the doctrinal substance.

The phrase rendered "great ash" for "thal chen" refers to a ritual substance, likely ash from a cremation ground or a powerful burned substance used in wrathful rites.

- The text breaks off mid-sentence in the colophon, ending with "Dar—", which suggests the manuscript or input is incomplete at this point. The translator named at the end is almost certainly Nyan-lo-tsā-ba Dar-ma-grags, a well-known Tibetan translator of the later diffusion period; the name is simply cut short in the source.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.